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TRIUMPH OF COMMUNISM

Nikita Khrushchev's inauguration as the world leader of communism took place in October 1961, just as American and Soviet tanks confronted each other at Checkpoint Charlie in divided Berlin. What amounted to induction into the communist hall of fame took place in Moscow, where a congress of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union was held from October 17 to 31.

Numbered twenty-second in the party's history, it entered the annals as the congress of the "builders of communism." At that assembly, the party of Lenin, Stalin, and now Khrushchev adopted its third and final program. The first party program, adopted in 1902, had announced the goal of toppling Russian authoritarianism; the second, approved in 1919, had put the party in charge of building a socialist state; and the third was to announce the construction of communism. To celebrate the impending victory of communism, Khrushchev had invited Vasilii Shulgin, a member of the Russian imperial parliament, or Duma, who had attended the abdication of